

4.1.5 Technical Knowledge

The amount of technical knowledge that you need is not too much. However, you need to have an understanding of all the relevant technologies that you will use. In the initial days, when you are “bootstrapping” yourself, what is more important is getting the content up and getting your audience.

Nevertheless, as you get more proficient with your blog you will want to do many things that you think will improve your blog—both in terms of look and feel as well as in the functioning. For example if you are using the Blogger platform, the default comments launch in a separate window. If you want to change this to allow comments on the same page you will need to have an understanding of how you can go about changing this. Ideally, you should be able to make any changes that you want without having to depend on anybody else. This may not be possible for everyone and even if you are not a master you should learn about it sufficiently enough to be able give detailed instructions to a software developer or Web designer if required.

The technologies and topics you need to familiarise yourself with include: HTML/CSS, blog publishing software, blogging comments and comments spam, RSS/Atom syndication, full vs. partial feeds, pings and trackbacks, blog carnivals, traffic analysis, social bookmarking and tagging, contextual advertising, cost per click and cost per action, search engine and search engine optimization, page rank and scripting languages like PHP and Python.

Additionally, if you want to sell products and downloadable “digital assets” like eBooks you need to further educate yourself on ecommerce, shopping carts, FTP, SSL and online databases.

You also need to keep a look out for the constantly evolving technology landscape. Any new technology that you come across and don’t understand, immediately Google for it or browse through Wikipedia to determine whether it will have any impact